

COMPLETE EDITION

The Career Evidence Working Page

Turn broad claims into credible evidence.

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The Career Evidence Working Page is a Career Weekly briefing for one real career situation. Read the argument first; use the working pages only after you can name the decision they are meant to improve.

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A résumé is a reading problem before it is a writing problem. A hiring reader needs to understand the setting, the decision, and the contribution without filling in the gaps from a flattering adjective.

For the career evidence working page, the useful test is whether the reader can understand the context, the judgment involved, and the evidence that would support the conclusion.

That standard is deliberately practical. It gives a working professional a way to improve the explanation without pretending that every outcome can be controlled or reduced to a single metric.

Read this section as an argument about what deserves attention first. The working pages come later, once the distinction is clear enough to apply to a real situation.

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Start with the reader's question: what changed, what did this person actually do, and what evidence makes the claim credible? The strongest language follows the evidence rather than trying to substitute for it.

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A weak statement announces a trait. A useful statement gives the operating context, the action, and a result that can be discussed honestly. That structure remains useful even when the target role or industry changes.

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Use the role description as a translation prompt, not as a vocabulary bank. Preserve the language that is genuinely relevant, then connect it to work you can explain with concrete detail.

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The common failure is compression without context: a string of verbs and numbers that sounds energetic but leaves the reader unable to tell what was difficult, what was yours, or why it mattered.

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Use the career evidence working page as a lens on one role, project, conversation, or offer. Begin with the facts available to you, label the assumptions, and keep the claim small enough to explain without performance.

The aim is not to produce a perfect sentence or a universal answer. It is to make the next conversation, application, or decision more informed than it would have been from instinct alone.

A useful test is transfer: could another person understand what happened, what you contributed, and what you would do next? If not, the missing work is usually context or judgment, not more polish.

Keep the conclusion proportionate to the evidence. Precision is not the same as certainty; it is the discipline of saying what the available facts can support and what still needs to be learned.

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Now move from explanation to application. Keep the page concrete: one situation, one claim, one decision, and one piece of evidence that another person could reasonably assess.

If the evidence is missing, record that as a finding rather than filling the gap with stronger language. A useful working page makes the next question easier to ask.

WORKING PROMPT

Write one accurate example from your own experience. Name the context, the action, the constraint, and the evidence another person could evaluate.

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SOURCE NOTES

U.S. Department of Labor — Job Seekers · <https://www.dol.gov/agencies/eta/job-seekers>